

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 7 4

♥ 6

♦ A Q 8

♣ K Q J 7 5

♠ A 8 5 3

♥ Q 7 4

♦ 9 7 6 2

♣ 8 3



♠ J 10 2

♥ 9 8 3

♦ J 10 4

♣ 9 6 4 2

♠ K 6

♥ A K J 10 5 2

♦ K 5 3

♣ A 10

West

1 ♣

Pass

Pass

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

over-ruff. Otherwise you ruff with a small trump.

North

Pass

1 ♠

4 ♥

East

Pass

Pass

South

Dbl

3 ♥

North realizes that to make a takeout double, then jump in your own suit you must have a very good hand. So he bids the game. South plays 4 ♥. West leads the ♣K, which you take with the ♣A.

You have four losers. If you are thinking about leading toward your ♦K you are delusionary. West has the ♦A and you know it. Your best hope is to end-play West with the ♣10 and force him to break the ♦s.

Play one round of trumps with the ♥A. You can't play any more because you will need an entry to dummy for the elimination.

Next play ♠K, ♠A and ruff a ♠ high.

Lead a ♥ to dummy's ♥Q. West shows out. Play dummy's last ♠. East is now void, so if he ruffs you

Now throw West in (you hope!) with the ♣10.

Fortunately West has to take the ♣10. Since he has nothing left but ♣s and ♦s he must lead one or the other. A ♦ lead will give you a trick with your ♦K and a ♣ lead will allow you to ruff in dummy (East still has a ♣) and discard a ♦ from your hand.

Some problems are tougher than others, this being a tough one.

It was not a complete elimination since East still had a trump when you threw West in. However, it worked because West was out of both ♠s and ♥s.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4
♥ K J 9 5
♦ Q J 10 4
♣ Q 10 9 2

♠ J 10 9 7 5

♥ 7

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ K 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 8

♥ Q 10 8 4 2

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ A J 8

♠ A K Q 6 3 2

♥ A 6 3

♦ 7

♣ 7 6 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠

Pass 4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by South
a winner. But it will still prove to be useful.

South is to play 4 ♠. West leads the ♦ Q.

Unless West is real beginner East will hold the ♦ A so you should not try the ♦ K on this trick. And when West continues with the ♦ J you should again duck in dummy, ruffing with an honor in your hand.

The contract is in danger if East holds the ♣ A because you would have three ♣ losers to go with the ♦ already lost. One really good possibility is that East now has the lone ♦ A and you can set up dummy's ♦ K with a ruff.

So play a small ♠ to dummy's ♠ 9, (pulling the two outstanding trumps), and ruff another ♦ with an honor, hoping the ♦ A drops.

Too bad, the ♦ A did not fall so dummy's ♦ K is not

Play the ♥ A, then ruff a ♥ in dummy. Play a trump to your ♠ A and ruff your last ♥.

You are in dummy, just where you want to be. Play the ♦ K, and when East plays the ♦ A don't ruff but instead discard a ♣ from your hand. You knew all along that he held the ♦ A.

[showcards N:SJ,CK,C5,C3 S:S6,S3,C7,C6]

East is end-played, forced to either break the ♣ s and give you a ♣ trick, or give you a ruff-sluff.

This was the toughest hand so far and the end-play depended upon your correct reading that East must hold the ♦ A.

It also depended upon the defenders not switching to ♣ s at the second trick. If West had decided to switch to the ♣ Q you would have had no chance at all.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 5 2

♥ 6

♦ Q 9 7

♣ K Q 5 2

♠ 7 6

♥ K J 7 2

♦ A K 6 4

♣ 10 8 3



♠ K 9 4 3

♥ 8 5

♦ 10 8 5 3 2

♣ 7 6

♠ A J

♥ A Q 10 9 4 3

♦ J

♣ A J 9 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

♥10 to dummy's ♥K, pulling the last trump as you enter dummy.

After hearing a limit raise, South's leap to 6♥ is, well, bold let's say. South plays 6♥. West leads the ♠5, East plays the ♠K.

Very bold in fact. The opening lead has exposed a ♠ loser in addition to your two ♣ losers. On the plus side dummy has an extra ♦ trick. You are going to have to try to throw West in with the ♣ suit, but you will have to be very careful with dummy's entries.

Win the ♠A, play the ♦J to dummy's ♦K and discard the ♠J on dummy's ♦A.

You are in dummy, so ruff the ♠7 with a high trump. Next play the ♥9 to dummy's ♥J. Both defenders follow, whew!

Back in dummy, ruff a ♦ with the ♥Q, then lead the

It would be great if you could ruff dummy's last ♦, then get back to dummy with a trump so you could lead a ♣ from dummy and finesse. But check your trumps. If you do that you will have no more trumps in your hand and West won't be endplayed because you have no ruff-sluff. The only thing you can do is to go ahead and play ♣s now, finessing into West and HOPING he has no more ♦s!

You were lucky, West had only three ♦s so your partial elimination worked.

But if it had turned out that West DID have another ♦, and led it, all would not be lost. You would ruff in your hand, play a trump to dummy, then take a second ♣ finesse. If it turned out the ♣K and ♣Q were in different hands you would make the slam.